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**OPEN
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 BREW AND
 DELIVER
 THE
 PERFECT
 CHAI.**
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At a time when the market is witnessing the mushrooming of coffee outlets like Café Coffee Day, Barista, Costa Coffee, Starbucks, etc, Chai Point has dared to offer tea to its customers! There is, however, a silent but significant contributor to the success of its business — open source powered IoT and AI. **Shirish Sruti, VP, Chai Point**, talks to **Syeda Beenish of OSFY** about the role of open source in the success of the startup, which now has a presence in eight cities. The excerpts...

Q Does open source make sense for a startup like yours?

Yes, when you are starting small, it is impossible to invest in technology. You can't blindly expect good returns. That is where open source technologies play an important role. If you are starting small but looking to do quick business, then adopting open source helps you jump-start your tech solutions.

Q What role has open source played in the success of Chai Point?

Open source is the perfect technology ingredient for Chai Point. We use a lot of open source technologies. Right

from our IDE, which is Eclipse, to other enterprise technologies like Tomcat, Spring, Linux, Redis and MySQL, we rely heavily on open source projects.

Just to share an example, an open source database like CouchDB, with its support for replication, helped us to capture daily sales reports from across the country into a central server.

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*In the future, we
 look forward to
 contributing to the
 open source world
 ourselves.*
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The **Shark** platform is a cloud based F&B platform. With every store connected to Chai Point's central Shark platform, the data gets to central servers in near real-time. This data helps Chai Point in supply chain predictions, as well as minimises wastage in stores and boxC.in locations. Also, lack of supply means a loss of business/sales; thus the Shark platform is critical -- it provides real-time data that reduces operational costs, in terms of inventory.